

Before too much suspense could be built up in the news; the story was snuffed. According to Martin, a diversionary tactic to keep everybody out of the crash area, the authorities told the police that the object, a meteorite, fell well beyond El Yunque and that investigations had been called off.

Not so, said Martin, who talked with Benjamin Gascot, officer for the air rescue division operating out of Isla Grande Airport. According to Gascot, "Something was wrong about this incident because we as a group of officials always worked together in the past". Martin also learned from the officer that on the morning of the investigation a mysterious helicopter, painted black and without identification showed up at the site. "The occupants" he said, "were dressed in military fatigues and in plain clothes," adding, "we were advised not to talk to the crew."

Confirmation came from another firsthand source, Michael Pazo, who operated a refueling station at the Isla Grande Airport. He, too, had seen the helicopter, identified as a Chinook, that brought in the military personnel and further claimed that El Yunque had been under military surveillance for three weeks. Pazo also stated that the object that crashed was "very radioactive" and that he, being a witness to the activities, was told by a federal agent, named Swaggart, to "keep things quiet or else..." Still another source, according to Martin, claimed that a second helicopter landed two days later with more personnel and that a Learjet, with NASA markings, flew over the El Yunque area for two weeks.

Of Martin's many sources, one working in security (unknown to me), provided him with details of the on-site "packaging" of the pieces of metal from the wreckage. Said the informant, the parts were catalogued, labeled and protectively wrapped before being boxed conforming to the exact size of each artifact. Then, the wooden boxes were sprayed with a leaded paint, followed by another coat of a chemical substance, the color of fuchsia.

Still hoping to get some kind of official response to the crash, Martin said he asked Barry Greenwood to check with the FAA. Word came back from an official of its Southeast Division: no such incident took place. For Martin, it was a flat denial of everything he had heard from scores of firsthand sources. For me, it was one more case in keeping with the coverup of all UFO crashes and retrievals and to hide the evidence at all costs.

CASE 14) John Lear, MUFON State Director for Nevada, undaunted in his pursuit of people, anywhere, to get UFO facts, has extensively lectured and made several radio and TV appearances in Las Vegas, to tell his story. Listening was "Mike", (real name withheld on request) who surfaced, in September 1988, to tell Lear his firsthand story. Admittedly troubled by his experience, Mike explained that in 1973 he had been an air force photographer stationed in Hawaii, following duty in Vietnam. His prime duty there was processing gun camera film. One day, he said, he was notified that his security clearance had been upgraded and several weeks later he and another photographer in his unit were flown, for a temporary duty assignment, to Norton AFB in California.

Lear's letter to me, November 21, 1988, recounting briefly his interview with Mike is paraphrased as follows:

On landing at Norton, Mike and companion were taken by air force vehicle with windows blacked out on a two hour drive. During the drive, Mike was told by the driver, "So you guys are going to photograph the UFO, eh?"

The vehicle came to a halt on a platform which was then lowered into a large underground installation. Escorted to a briefing room they were told that they were to photograph a flying saucer and the autopsy of three dead aliens. Ordered to disrobe, they were issued white smocks and combat boots for security purposes. Mike was then escorted into the installation where he saw a disc-shaped craft about 30 feet in diameter contained in a heavy net suspended from a large crane.

Mike was boosted into the opening of the disc (no stairs or ramp) and proceeded to crawl inside. He was shocked, he said, to find that the inside looked to be about 10 times the size of the outside. He commented, "I could have thrown a football as hard as I could and not hit the other side." Disoriented, Mike poked his head back outside to check the size which appeared to be about 30 feet in diameter as before. Once inside he met two persons similarly clothed in white smocks who showed him what they wanted photographed. He shot many photos of control panels and various other fixtures and later was asked to photograph the exterior from different angles and distances.

He was later taken to a room in which there were three dead aliens. He described them as approximately 5 feet tall, with almost normal, human heads except the eyes were more rounded. The skin texture was of baking dough, very white. Before the autopsy the aliens had been dressed in blue uniforms, like flight suits.

As the initial incisions were made for the autopsy, Mike saw green fluid and black innards. At this time he became ill and called for the other photographer to continue the assignment. Later that day they were driven back to Norton where they spent the night and were flown out the next day to Hawaii. About two months later Mike's companion disappeared and neither Mike or his family have heard from him since.

The year 1973 brings to mind Case A-2, *Status Report II*, where three humanoids were examined at Wright-Patterson AFB. While the head sizes described in each case differ and the body heights also differ by a foot or so, the description of the skin is strikingly similar. According to the sergeant, in Case A-2, who stood guard in the underground facility, the color was "off white or cream." Both observers, it should be noted, were admittedly, traumatized by the sight of alien bodies which could account for visual differences of anatomical sizes and heights.